Extensions

We've covered the bulk of PHP's core "Math" API, and that should be sufficient for any trivial use case and quite a few non-trivial ones too. If the time comes, however, when the core toolkit is proving to hinder rather than help your work, there are some PHP extensions available. The two extensions that we're going to look at here might not be installed on your system; you can check by running the following command:

```
$ php -m
Output:
[PHP Modules]
bcmath
Core
...
gmp
...
xmlwriter
zlib
```

For the examples in the section to work, the modules `bcmath` and `gmp` need to be listed in the output. See Chapter 1, "Getting Started," for information on installing language extensions if you don't see these modules listed.

BCMath

BCMath exists for when you simply need to deal with numbers that are too big even for a 64-bit system. It allows the manipulation of arbitrary precision numbers (integers and decimals) as numeric strings. Numerical strings will also work but emit a warning error.